AARUSHI CHUGH, MBA

Los Angeles, California | aarushi.chg@gmail.com | 341-208-9015 | linkedin.com/in/aarushi-chugh | Portfolio

EDUCATION

USC Marshall School of Business, Master of Business Administration (STEM), Dean's List | Los Angeles, CA **2024 – 2026**

- Elected Class President for a class of 400, serving as the voice of the student body to the deans and leading class-wide programming
- Co-designed "AI for Business Leaders," USC Marshall's first MBA AI core course, taught to the Class of 2028
- #1 USC Finalist, Kellogg Healthcare and Biotech Case Competition; earned special recognition for an AI-assisted disease prevention strategy
- #1 USC Finalist and Best Due Diligence Award, Turner MIINT, pitching Climatize, an SEC-regulated renewable energy investment platform

Wilfrid Laurier University, Bachelor of Business Administration | Waterloo, Canada **2016**

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Diaspora Health, Chief of Staff (Founding Member) | AI-native behavioral health platform **2026 – Present**

- Took 3 pilot clinics from signed contract to production in under 6 months, lifting clinic revenue 15% across 1K+ claims by building insurance reimbursement workflows with 50 payers and billing companies
- Freed ~2,600 clinic staff hours a year by building a voice AI agent (Twilio, Deepgram, OpenAI, Cartesia) that calls insurers to verify patient benefits, QA-testing every release against live payer calls
- Built a model forecasting out-of-network patient payments before treatment at 94% accuracy across 1K+ claims
- Built pitch decks, board materials, and investor updates supporting selection for Google for Startups, Nvidia Inception, Techstars, and a USC grant; ran pre-seed VC outreach and investor call prep

Adaptovate, AI Transformation MBA Intern (Scrum Master) | Agile management consulting firm **2025**

- Launched an enterprise AI academy for Fortune 500 clients in financial services, FMCG, and IT in 2 weeks from concept to go-live, reaching 96% completion across 100+ learners by shaping its learning architecture and LLM content strategy
- Raised sprint velocity 25% for a 9-member delivery team as Scrum Master by running sprint ceremonies and removing blockers
- Cut proposal effort from 2 days to a 1-hour review by deploying the firm's internal GPT to draft RFP responses from prior proposals

Carpedia International, Senior Management Consultant | PE-backed management consulting firm focused on implementation **2022 – 2024**

- Identified ~$6M in annualized excess labor cost across 12 home health sites by tracing overruns to overtime reliance and incorrect system inputs, then designed the staffing plan architecture and rolled it out to close the gap
- Built a capacity and staffing model for a home health client with 80+ locations, interviewing 5 leaders per site and matching care hours to worker availability; automated it from Excel to Power BI, cutting reporting time 80% and lifting utilization to 80%
- Hit the client's 10% admin headcount reduction target by inventorying every duty across 40+ admin staff, consolidating roles across nearby sites, and standardizing SOPs that cut admin time 40%
- Delivered $2M in annual savings for a hospitality client across US and Canadian properties by running week-long on-site time studies and building playbooks for housekeeping, guest services, and maintenance teams
- Advised client C-suite across 4 workstreams (cost, revenue, staffing policy, operations policy) to sequence the implementation roadmap, and ran WBRs and MBRs for teams of 10+ from an implementation tracker

The People People, Fractional Strategy & Operations Director (Contract) | Strategy and operations advisory **2024**

- Ran diagnostics for 4 seed to Series C clients through stakeholder interviews and process audits, redesigning people ops, payroll, and handbook workflows with technology to cut time spent 75%
- Built operating model roadmaps that cut overstaffing 20%, and designed salary bands and job architecture for 25 mid-level to senior roles

Wattpad / Webtoon Studios, Head of People Operations | Acquired by Naver for $600M **2020 – 2022**

- Led change management for 400+ employees across 6 countries through Naver's $600M acquisition, running company-wide town halls and working across the Toronto and LA offices to keep teams aligned through integration
- Launched company-wide OKR planning in Culture Amp, tying every department's goals to company priorities, and set up and ran the weekly C-suite meeting, driving next steps and prioritization across leadership
- Cut weekly reporting time 70% for 10 C-suite leaders by building a one-page people analytics dashboard on BambooHR, Lever, and Culture Amp data, tracking turnover, engagement, and diversity by department
- Scaled People Operations from a team of 1 to 6 to deliver a 100-person hiring mandate, hiring ~35 people a year at a 25-day time-to-fill and 80-90% offer acceptance; promoted to lead the function in under a year

Scotiabank, Contingent Workforce Program Lead (PMO) | Toronto, Canada **2017 – 2019**

- Saved the bank $1M annually as a founding member of the Contingent Workforce Program PMO by running contractor furloughs and leading MSA reviews and contract negotiations with 60+ staffing vendors
- Owned the preferred vendor list and workstreams for contractor onboarding, lifecycle policies, screening, and workforce forecasting

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- **Consulting:** Cost optimization, operating model design, PMO and governance, value realization, change management, Agile and Scrum
- **Tools:** Excel modeling, PowerPoint, Power BI, Looker, SQL, Jira, Asana, Notion, Replit, Claude, ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot
- **Certifications:** Certified ScrumMaster (CSM), Lean Six Sigma Yellow Belt, CHRL, Performance Leadership (eCornell)
- **Interests:** Run a side business planning South Asian weddings with $150K+ budgets across Canada and California